

1.1.1 User Interface

User Interface features are similar in Home Premium, Professional and Ultimate. However, Home Basic lacks the Aero UI with Aero Peek, Aero Shake, and Flip 3D all missing. Live Previews in Windows Explorer is also not available. The Starter Edition offers a very basic UI and apart from what's missing in Home Basic, it lacks Live Taskbar previews also.

1.1.2 Performance

Home Premium, Professional and Ultimate support two physical processors, whereas Home Basic and Starter are limited to single processor support. Physical processors is not equal to multi-core and all variants offer multi-core support.

Also, Home Basic and Starter only come in 32-bit versions resulting in a limitation (below 4 GB) to the maximum RAM supported. 64 bit Home Premium can however support 16 GB and Professional and Ultimate 64 bit offers support for up to a whopping 192 GB of RAM.

1.1.3 Reliability

Ultimate variant has BitLocker, and BitLocker To Go encryption technology which is missing from all others. Also, Professional and Ultimate offer backing up to a network and encryption of the File system which is not there in all Home Variants and the Starter Edition.

1.1.4 Bundled Applications

Home Premium, Professional and Ultimate come with its own Snipping Tool, Sticky notes and Windows Journal. These utilities are missing from Home Basic and the Starter Edition.

1.1.5 Multimedia

Home Basic and Starter variants do not offer Windows Media Center, DVD playback, MPEG-2 decoding and Dolby Digital compatibility like Home Premium, Professional and Ultimate. Home Basic and Starter do not support TV tuners while the other variants can support up to 4 tuners each of analogue and digital TV.

1.1.6 Networking

Home Basic and Starter can only join a HomeGroup and not start HomeGroup sharing whereas other variants can start their own HomeGroup. Starter